and responded by saying that, given the critical state our country was in, it was no longer a matter of safeguarding personal image but of safeguarding the nation. This was not about protecting any political party or leader, but about standing up against forces that threatened to undermine our democracy and Constitution. One cannot simply stand on the sidelines and remain neutral. Therefore, I made it clear that I would be part of the Bharat Jodo Yatra and, if possible, walk the entire length it traversed.

Working in the social sector for a long time meant that when civil society decided to participate in the Bharat Jodo Yatra, I was part of the preparatory meetings. In these meetings several literary personalities, artists, social workers and Congress representatives participated, and I learnt about the objective and the route of the Bharat Jodo Yatra. My heartfelt desire was to accompany this Yatra from Kanyakumari to Kashmir, but my back pain stopped me and I spent a long time undergoing treatment at the Ayush hospital in Bhilwara.

During this, I followed the Bharat Jodo Yatra continuously and hoped that when the Yatra reached Madhya Pradesh, I would participate in it, although this was not possible even then. In the end, I chose to take on a role in coordination and actively engaged with the group working to facilitate the participation of people from the social sector in Rajasthan in the Yatra. My primary objective was to ensure that they connected with Rahul Gandhi and engaged in meaningful interactions.

As Rahul ji’s Yatra progressed, he started gaining immense popularity and tremendous public support. This was a shocking phenomenon for the ruling BJP, the media, which has in almost every way bowed down to power, and the harshest critics of Rahul Gandhi. When the Bharat Jodo Yatra completed a hundred days, I got the opportunity to be part of it. The Yatra had now reached my home state, Rajasthan, and I had nearly fully recuperated. I was eager to directly participate in it. I responded promptly to the invitation received via email, expressing my interest in joining the Yatra when it approached the Dausa district of Rajasthan. I received a confirmation email and a call from the Bharat Jodo Yatra organizing team, informing me that I would have the opportunity to meet Rahul Gandhi in